NREIB

NATIONAL RESEARCH ETHICS & INNOVATION BOARD (DEMO)

P.O. Box 00000-00100, Nairobi, Kenya · ethics@nreib-demo.example · Fictional body for system testing

CERTIFICATE OF ETHICAL APPROVAL

Issued under the Board's Standard Operating Procedures for Research Involving Human Participants

Ref. No: NREIB/ERC/2025/0417 **Date of Issue: 22 September 2025**

This is to certify that the research protocol described below has been reviewed by the National Research Ethics & Innovation Board (Demo) at its full-board meeting of 15 September 2025 and is hereby **APPROVED**, subject to the conditions set out in this certificate.

Study title	TRIAGE-KE: Evaluating an AI-Assisted Clinical Triage Decision-Support Tool in Emergency Departments of Kenyan County Referral Hospitals — A Mixed-Methods Implementation Study
Principal Investigator	Joy Owango
Co-Investigators	Dr Amani Wekesa; Dr Faith Chebet; Prof Daniel Otieno Mbugua; Ms Grace Njeri Kamau
Host institution	Hospitium Institute of Health Sciences (Demo), Nairobi
Study sites	Emergency departments of county referral hospitals in Kisumu, Nakuru and Machakos counties
Protocol version	Version 2.1, dated 5 September 2025
Research type	Observational / implementation study (mixed methods)
Risk category	Low risk
Approved sample	≈ 3,600 de-identified ED encounters; up to 60 clinician survey respondents; up to 30 key-informant interviews
Consent	Waiver of individual consent approved for de-identified record abstraction (with opt-out notices); written informed consent for clinician survey and interviews
Approval period	22 September 2025 to 21 September 2027
Continuing review	Annual progress report due by 21 August 2026

Conditions of Approval

1. Only the approved protocol, consent forms and data collection tools may be used. Any amendment must be approved by the Board before it is implemented.
2. Serious adverse events and unanticipated problems, including any safety signal arising from the AI tool, must be reported within 72 hours.
3. The pre-specified stopping rule (under-triage > 5 percentage points above baseline for two consecutive weeks) must be applied and reported.
4. Data must be handled in line with the Kenya Data Protection Act (2019) and the approved Data Protection Impact Assessment.
5. Separate authorisation must be obtained from each participating county's health department before data collection starts.
6. A final report and copies of resulting publications must be submitted to the Board within 90 days of study completion.

[signature — sample]

Dr Miriam A. Odhiambo
Chairperson, NREIB (Demo)

APPROVED
22 SEP 2025

[signature — sample]

Mr Peter K. Langat
Secretary, NREIB (Demo)

Verification code: NREIB-7Q4K-2025-0417 · This certificate must be presented with the approved protocol on request.

SAMPLE DOCUMENT FOR HOSPITIUMRIS TESTING — fictional ethics board; not a valid approval.